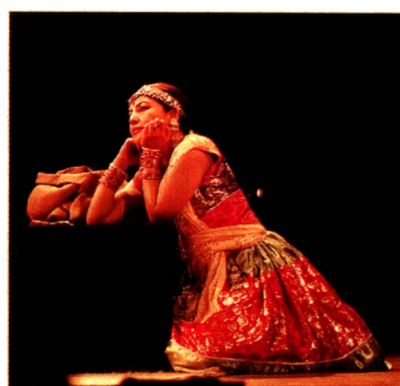




THEATRE

A Stage for the MASSES

Beginning March 8, a heady banquet for theatre lovers comes to several venues in Delhi, Mumbai and Kolkata. The South Asian Theatre Festival, organised by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations, offers well-known plays from across the country besides some from South Asian countries. Here are some of the best-known.

SAKUBAI One of Nadira Babbar's best-known plays, it has been part of the Mumbai theatre circuit for over 10 years now. The play revolves around the life of Sakubai (Sarita Joshi), a household maid and her travails. Babbar's quest to infuse the play with emotion is both the strength as well as the weakness of the play.

NAGAMANDALA First performed in 1989, this legendary play by Girish Karnad was revived, or rather revisited, as a new production by Neelam Mansingh in 2005. *Nagamandala* is a theatrical delight in any language and the rural flavour bestowed on it by Mansingh and her incredible team of actors only adds to the drama.

NATI BINODINI Based on the life of one of India's first few women actresses, *Nati Binodini* directed by Amal Allana is an extravagant production in every way. From

the design and sets to the decision to have five actresses portraying Binodini at various stages of her life, the stylised rendition manages to engage.

ON THE ROAD FOR THE YOUTH A street theatre performance by Tshering Gyeltshen from the New Theatre Company in Bhutan. The production is a visual delight with almost ritualistic portrayal of action and drama. The play tells the story of modern Bhutan caught as it is between two worlds—the old and the new.

A DOLL'S HOUSE In Nepalese, this production by Aarohan Theatre Group, directed by Sunil Pokharel and written by Henrik Ibsen, has travelled across the world. The play dwells on the social and emotional position of Nora, a housewife and the machinations of the various people that inhabit her life. **by Nirmala Ravindran**



SIPRA DAS/www.indiatodayimages.com

FESTIVAL

Indian Tribute

The Vimla Devi Foundation, conceptualised by the royal family of Ayodhya, organises an annual festival of music, dance and literature on the banks of the Sarayu. Experience the charm of the fine performances in the ancient town from March 5 to March 7. The line-up includes Rudra veena maestro Asad Ali Khan, Qawwali group Ahmed Khan Warsi and party, Bharatanatyam dancer Geeta Chandran and group, Kathak dancer Prerna Shrimali, and conversations with lyricist Gulzar.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

FESTIVAL

Sound of Harmony



What Tabla player Sandeep Das has formed a quartet called the HUM Ensemble in India.

Who Das with fellow musicians like Cristina Pato, Wu Tong, Sheng will present some original melodies.

When and Where On March 7 at Kamani Auditorium, Delhi.